Talks Style Guide

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Manuscripts are papers; talks are presentations that maximize appeal, so they get leeway. The rules split in two: what is kept for correctness and reuse, and what is free. Agents follow `.setup/ai/style/talks.md`, which follows this guide and is changed together with it.

1 Kept

These are checked by `make lint`, as in papers.

- Math: `\boldsymbol`, portable commands, and the shared notation, so that an equation pasted from a paper renders the same.
- R code and file names, since talks are R packages.
- Citations: any biblatex-apa command (`\parencite`, `\textcite`, `\footcite`, `\fullcite`), with lib-* keys only and no typed references.
- One body (`.setup/latex/slides/talk.tex`) for slides, notes, and handout. A talk with slides only may skip the wrappers.
- Accessibility floor: meaning is never shown by colour alone. Add a shape, line type, label, or position.

2 Free

This is guidance, not lint.

- Colours: the Penn State theme and any palette that helps the slide (Okabe-Ito recommended), within the floor above.
- Figure sizes: any; `scale` and `width` are allowed. `Fig*(size = "slide")` gives slide fonts.
- TikZ inline in frames, or from `.setup/latex/tikz` (recommended when a paper uses the same diagram).
- Layout: semantic line breaks and tabs are recommended; no APA captions, labels, or notes.
- Images and photos in PNG or JPG.
- GIFs: free, except the floor, no flashing faster than 3 per second, and alt text on the web.

3 Formats

3.1 Beamer

`beamerthemePSU`, with one body and three wrappers (slides, notes for pympress, handout). Animations play with \`PSUanimation` (PNG frames) or \`PSUanimationpdf` (a multi-page PDF).

3.2 Reveal.js

Quarto Reveal.js, from `.setup/quarto`. Use GIFs directly and the same math (MathJax: no \`bm`).

4 Lifetime

Finished talks are still checked; there is no skip after the talk's date. Older talks follow the rules when next reused.

5 Tools

`make lint` uses a talk profile for project type `talk`: it runs the kept checks and skips the free ones.

References

R Core Team. (2026). *R: A language and environment for statistical computing*. R Foundation for Statistical Computing. Vienna, Austria. https://www.R-project.org/